

Streaking Midpark ropes Rangers

Steve Byrne
Chronicle-Telegram

MIDDLEBURG HEIGHTS — It was only your average 42-point victory.

For Midpark, that almost is average.

"They aren't ranked eighth or ninth for nothing," Coach Dan Rademaker said after watching his North Ridgeville team take a 91-49 pounding from the unbeaten Meteors. "I thought our kids played well at times, especially in the first half. We just couldn't maintain it."

"That (Midpark) is a team that has a little of everything."

Midpark, rated No. 9 in Division I, established dominance three minutes into the game with a 13-4 run over 3:14 that opened a 22-12 lead with a little less than two minutes remaining in the first quarter.

North Ridgeville (4-7, 2-5 Pioneer Conference) got within 11 points with an 8-2 burst that ended at 1:38 to play in the second period, but the Meteors finished by scoring the last seven points of the first half to make it an 18-point margin at the break.

The Meteors made 20 of their 34 field-goal tries in the first half. The Rangers hit a dozen in 31 attempts.

The second half was all Midpark, as the Meteors (12-0, 7-0 Pioneer) kept building on the lead in the third quarter and enjoyed a run of 16 unanswered points in the final period.

Coach Duane Sheldon was

NRHS				Midpark			
Nelson	5	0	11	Pleasick	5	0	11
Davin	5	0	4	Carroll	9	2	21
Mook	5	1	11	Akkinkoye	6	1	13
Thompson	4	0	9	Johnson	6	3	18
Lime	2	0	5	Nuzzo	5	0	11
Mintmyr	0	0	0	Swidmnn	1	0	2
Workman	0	0	0	Ferrini	0	0	0
Barrett	2	0	7	Hawkins	3	0	6
Witter	0	0	0	Kubicky	0	0	0
Manning	1	0	2	Lombardo	3	0	9
				Nagel	0	0	0
				Mannella	1	0	2
Totals	21	4	49	Totals	38	9	91
Points by Quarters							
	1	2	3	4			T
NRHS	16	13	13	7	49		
Midpark	22	22	21	25	91		
Three-point goals: Lombardo 3, Thompson, Nelson, Lime, Nuzzo, Carroll, Johnson							
Junior varsity: North Ridgeville, 42-39							

happy with the way his team performed.

"I don't think North Ridgeville's a pushover," Sheldon said. "The players took that challenge and played well. What did (North Ridgeville) score in the fourth quarter? Our pressure took a toll on them and wore them down."

All Midpark starters scored in double figures, led by David Pisarcik with 21 and Rahshan Johnson with 16. Mike Nuzzo had an excellent second half for the Meteors with nine of his 11 points and nine of his team-leading 12 rebounds.

Midpark made 38 of 80 field-goal attempts and had a 28-8 turnover advantage.

The Rangers hit 21 of 57 from the field and were led by Chad Nelson and Tyler Mook with 11 points each.

Mook grabbed 12 rebounds and Brad Thompson followed with 11 as North Ridgeville held a 38-34 edge on the backboards.



TERRY MAHL / CHRONICLE

REBOUND AND DOWN: North Ridgeville's Tyler Mook grabs the rebound from team-mate Neal Barrett (32) and Midpark's Pedro Akinkuoye (top right) and David Piscarcik Friday night.

Oberlin dunks Falcons

Chris Assenheimer
The Chronicle-Telegram

HENRIETTA TWP. — When Firelands' Kyle Matus tripped and fell while running through the papier-mâché hoop during pre-game announcements, the Falcons should have realized it was going to be one of those nights.

And it was. Beaten in nearly every phase of the game Friday night, Firelands fell 88-69 to an Oberlin team that was clicking on all cylinders — and then some.

"We played well defensively," said Indians coach Al Pool after watching his team raise its record to 4-6 overall and 3-2 in the Lorain County Conference. "Defense is what got us the win tonight."

Defense, and a whole lot of Jessuh Williams.

Williams, a 6-foot-4 junior, was a man among boys, scoring 25 points and threw down a couple of dunks that brought the Oberlin faithful as well as a few of the Firelands fans to their feet.

It was Williams who gave the Indians their first 20-point lead midway through the fourth quarter, capping a 7-0 run with a jaw-dropping drive that put Oberlin in front, 76-55. He followed that with an alley-oop dunk that left him hanging on the rim after taking a perfect pass from senior point guard Glenn Smith.

"Jessuh likes to play to the crowd," Pool said. "He's starting to play more of a team game and look for the extra pass. Slowly but surely, I'm starting to get a lasso on him."

While Williams did most of the damage offensively, he did have some help. Senior Scottie White (16) and sophomore Andrew Gibbs (15) combined for 31 points, while Errol Barnes added 12. Gibbs teamed with Smith to haul down 18 rebounds.

For Firelands (3-7, 2-3), it was an all too familiar tale: not enough talent, not enough size and not enough quickness, equals another defeat.

Oberlin had the edge in every category — including a 46-25 rebounding advantage — except 3-point field goals, which kept the Falcons within striking distance until the final quarter. Firelands connected on eight 3s, with Matus sticking four of them to aid his game-high 18 points.

"We did the best we could, but we couldn't handle that kind of quickness," said Firelands coach Mike Horne, who saw his team make just 6 of 18 from the foul line. "I was happy with the way the kids finished, but it's tough to match their (Indians') size, strength and quickness."

Consecutive 3-pointers from Matus and Grant Krieg to start the second quarter tied the score at 23 before Oberlin hit Firelands with a 13-0 run that pushed the Indians' advantage into double digits.

The Falcons got it under 10 twice in the third quarter, but couldn't keep up with Oberlin, which turned it into a track meet in the fourth.

Pool has all but conceded the conference championship to either Midview (6-0) or Clearview (5-1), both of which stand atop the LCC standings. But the former Southview star issued a warning to anyone who runs into the Indians at the end of the year.

"We're coming around," he said. "We haven't given up on the conference, but we have to be realistic. By tournament time, I think we're going to be one of the better teams in the area."

Both teams will return to LCC action Tuesday. Oberlin hosts Wellington and the Falcons travel to Clearview.

Oberlin			Firelands		
G	F	T	G	F	T
Elliott	0	0	Rottari	1	1
White	7	1	Flynn	4	1
Smith	3	0	Matus	0	18
Williams	11	2	Tomlinson	5	2
Jarven	0	0	Krieg	3	13
Whitehead	3	1	Krieg	2	0
Gibbs	1	2	Kendish	2	0
Tarrant	1	3	Beyer	2	0
Jackson	0	2			4
Barnes	5	2			

Falls dumps Westlake, takes SWC lead

Bob Daniels
The Chronicle-Telegram

OLMSTED TWP. — Olmsted Falls, playing by the book, took the Southwestern Conference boys basketball lead with a 20-point win over Westlake Friday night.

The Bulldogs won 61-41, dominating the Demons on defense and at the foul line, which is the way tradition says you're supposed to do it.

The defense forced 22 Westlake turnovers, 15 the first half, and sent the Demons to the foul line only twice all night — both times in the first half.

The Bulldogs put the tarp on their seventh victory in nine games by making 11 of 12 foul shots in the fourth quarter. They shot only four times from the

Westlake				O'Falls			
Pusten	G	F	T	Mucha	G	F	T
Noel	1	0	2	Jarosek	0	0	0
Diamond	4	0	9	Boch	0	0	0
McClain	0	0	0	MWilliams	5	3	14
Rails	0	0	0	Stanton	0	1	1
Fiebig	1	3	5	Gareney	0	7	15
Verdova	2	0	4	BWilliams	0	0	0
Hrning	2	0	4	Flages	0	0	0
Robinson	5	0	10	Rodgen	3	3	9
				Holland	0	0	0
				Schuder	1	0	2
Totals 18 3 41				Totals 21 16 61			
Points by Quarters							
	1	2	3	4		T	
Westlake	8	15	8	10		41	
O'Falls	20	13	15	11		61	
Three-point goals: Westlake — Diamond, Noel, Olmsted Falls — Much 2 M Williams							
Junior Varsity: Westlake, 53-45							

floor in the fourth and made half of them.

With the victory, Falls, 6-1 in conference play, moves a game ahead of Westlake (6-6, 5-2) in the SWC.

And with it, the Bulldogs sweep the season series, having

whipped the Demons by 15 points at Westlake in December.

"Our defense is based on pressure on the ball," said Larry Mucha, a junior guard for the Bulldogs whose game-high 18 points were his personal high for the season.

"We played good defense tonight," Mucha said. "We've been working on converting turnovers into baskets, and that's what we did."

For sure.

Falls turned Westlake's 15 first-half turnovers into 18 points as it built a 33-23 lead at the break behind eight points each by Mucha and senior guard Sean Radigan.

The Bulldogs opened it to 15 points after three periods and Mucha got them rolling at the foul line less than a minute into

the fourth when he made four straight foul shots after bang-bang technicals on Westlake players.

This happened when James Noel of the Demons said the wrong thing in a discussion of issues with the refs and teammate Zarrett Fiebig responded by placekicking the ball toward the seats on the Bulldog side of the gym. It faded wide left.

Falls got the ball again after the technicals and turned it into a six-point play when junior Jake Schneider was fouled underneath and made both shots.

By then it was a 21-point lead, 52-31, and the rest was academic.

"We played hard and we played good defense," said Bulldog coach Pat Donahue. "Those are the main things we've got to do. We're not very big, but our kids are quick and athletic and

we have to take advantage of that."

"We told them, 'Let's pressure the heck out of the ball,' which we did," Donahue said. "I thought we got a little stagnant on offense in the second half, but overall, we're pleased."

Olmsted Falls got 15 points from Mike Gansey, a 6-foot-4 sophomore guard, and 14 from junior guard Manzie Williams.

Sophomore Marcus Robinson led Westlake with 10 points.

"We were at the hump a couple of times," said Westlake coach Art Daniels, "but we missed that easy shot and they got a basket off a steal and we never got over the hump. This is a young team, and we can learn from that."

Westlake will host Amherst Friday. Falls will be at North Olmsted the same night.

BRIEFS

On Target fencers qualify

The On Target Fencing Team from North Ridgeville qualified two teams to the Division I nationals in South Bend, Ind., April 16-19.

The women's foil team — Melissa Roman of Oberlin, Astrid Burnett of Oberlin and Tara Habernicht of North Ridgeville — took second behind Oberlin College (45-38) in the qualifying event. Both teams qualified for the nationals.

In the men's foil, Tom Nagy of North Ridgeville, Steve Brown of Oberlin and Dan Limpert of North Ridgeville, representing On Target, took second to Alcazar (45-20) in the qualifying event.

Both teams advanced to South Bend. On Target reached the finals by beating Oberlin College 45-42.

Northwood pins E. Heights

Northwood's wrestlers claimed the city junior high championship with their 63-12 win over Eastern Heights.

The Braves won 12 of the 15 matches, including nine by pin. The winners also had one win by a major decision.

RESULTS
82 — Paul Felton (N) won by pin; 88 — Brandon Saltman (EH) won by decision; 94 — Cory Mangera (N) won by pin; 100 — Todd Latta (N) won by pin; 106 — Josh McCann (N) won by pin; 112 — Josh Hopkins (N) won by major decision; 117 — Ale Bottomlee (N) won by pin; 122 — Dan McNeely (N) won by pin; 128 — Matt Sears (N) won by pin; 134 — Victor Winsel (N) won by pin; 141 — Taylor Hues (N) won by decision; 148 — Jerry Sen (EH) won by decision; 156 — Joe Lunden (N) won by decision; 169 — Shawn Sams (EH) won by forfeit; 177 — Steve Hessel (N) won by pin.

EC hockey game rescheduled

Elyria Catholic will play Greater Cleveland High School Hockey League-Blue West Division foe Parma in a make-up game on Monday.

The game, which was postponed on Jan. 13, will start at 8:45 p.m. at the North Park Ice Rink.

Tickets cost \$3 for youth and \$4 for adults. For more information, call (440) 365-4251.

SWC swimmers, divers meet

The Southwestern Conference Swimming and Diving Championships will be held Friday and Saturday, Feb. 5 and 6, at Rocky River High School.

Boys diving will start at 4:30 Friday, Feb. 5, with the girls to follow. Swimming will start at 9:30 a.m. on Saturday, Feb. 6.

All eight league schools will compete in both the girls and boys competitions.

Tickets, on sale at the door, are \$5 for adults and

\$33 for students. SWC passes will be honored.

Youth wrestling set in Vermilion

The Vermilion youth wrestling tournament scheduled for this Sunday has been rescheduled for Sunday, Feb. 14.

Competitors will be put in four age groups: 6 years, 7-8 years, 9-10 years and 11-12 years.

Weigh-ins will be held at Vermilion High School on Wednesday, Feb. 10. Entrants may also weigh in at the youth program where they attend and have their coaches phone in the entrants and their weights on Thursday, Feb. 11, or fax them to the high school at (440) 967-8317.

For more information, call Tom Dryfuss at (440) 967-7986.

GIRLS BASKETBALL

Royals seek crown

DAYTON — Lake Ridge out-scored New Creation School of Richmond, Ind., in every quarter Friday night to advance to the championship game of the Miami Valley School Tournament.

Lindsey Sommer and Sarah Evans combined for 30 points for the Royals.

Lake Ridge, 5-1, plays Miami Valley School in today's championship game.

LakeRidge			NwCrn						
G	F	T	G	F	T	G	F	T	
Hendrix	1	0	2	Taylor	3	0	9		
L Sommer	5	2	16	Schroeder	1	3	9		
K Sommer	4	1	9	Holmes	2	2	6		
Wallack	1	2	4	Fugate	2	1	5		
Evans	4	6	14	Hmrst	1	0	3		
Golem	0	1	1						
Bus	1	1	3						
Totals	17	13	49	Totals	9	6	24		
Points by Quarters			Points by Quarters						
1	2	3	4	T	1	2	3	4	T
LakeRidge	15	16	12	5	49				
NwCrn	7	8	9	1	25				
Three-point goals: Lake Ridge — L. Sommer 2									

Berea57
Bedford.....50

BEREA — The Braves enjoyed a 37-27 halftime lead en route to this non-conference win.

Carolyn Purdy (13), Allison James (12) and Shannon Lewis (10) scored in double figures for Berea.

The Braves, 8-4 and 5-2 PC, host Brecksville today for a Pioneer Conference game.

Bedford				Berea			
G	F	T	Points	G	F	T	Points
Burke	3	1	7	James	2	6	12
Booker	1	3	5	Seneque	2	0	5
Wagner	2	2	7	Purdy	4	4	13
Mathews	2	3	7	Peacock	3	2	8
Reese	5	3	13	Lewis	2	6	10
Johnson	3	0	6	Baughner	4	1	9
Lewis	0	5	5				
Totals	18	17	50	Totals	17	19	57
Points by Quarters				Points by Quarters			
	1	2	3	4	T		T
Bedford	15	12	6	7	50	Berea	17
Bedford	17	20	7	13	57	Berea	17
Three-point goals: Bedford — Wagner, Seneque — James, T. Seneque, Purdy.							